



Inspection Report

Wellington Conservation Center
14990 Palm Beach Point Blvd
Wellington, FL 33414

Customer ID: **329044**

Certificate: **58-C-1207**

Site: 001

Wellington Conservation Center

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 12-AUG-2026

2.40(b)(2)

Repeat

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility failed to follow up with the attending veterinarian when requested to. USDA inspectors observed a male capybara named Leonardo, with yellow mucous discharge coming from his right nostril. When inspectors asked about his condition, the licensee said the animal was on medication from the attending veterinarian (AV) and that the animal sometimes has this discharge and the AV did not know what it was. The USDA inspectors spoke to the AV and learned that the licensee had been instructed to report the animal's condition after completing the prescribed medication, particularly if the symptoms reappeared, as further diagnostic testing would be necessary. The AV reported that no follow up communication has been received from the licensee since July 16, 2026.

Follow up communication is essential for protecting an animal's health and well being, especially when symptoms return. Ongoing updates allow the veterinarian to reassess the situation quickly, determine whether a treatment plan is working, and identify new or worsening issues before they escalate. When owners or caretakers report recurring signs promptly, it ensures timely intervention, prevents complications, and supports a more accurate understanding of the animal's condition and ensures the animal receives the most effective care possible.

Each dealer or exhibitor shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries, and the availability of emergency, weekend, and holiday care.

3.75(c)(3)

Repeat

Housing facilities, general.

There is a buildup of dried fecal matter on the structures in the Black & White and Red Ruff lemur enclosures. In both enclosures, small plastic tables and chairs, and a cloth hammock had accumulation of dried fecal matter that was more than 24 hours old.

Failing to maintain clean conditions in areas accessible to nonhuman primates can lead to significant accumulations of debris and contaminants, increasing the risk of disease and compromising the health and welfare of the animals housed there.

Prepared By: MOIRA ROBERTS

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:

21-AUG-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Received by Title: Licensee

Date:

21-AUG-2026



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Hard surfaces with which nonhuman primates come in contact must be spot cleaned daily and sanitized in accordance with 3.84 of this subpart to prevent accumulation of excreta or disease hazards. Contaminated material must be removed or replaced whenever raking and spot cleaning does not eliminate odors, diseases, insects, pests, or vermin infestation.

3.84(d) Repeat

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility does not currently maintain an effective pest control program. There is a large quantity of rodent droppings in the garage that acts as the main food prep and storage area for the facility. While the facility does set traps, it is not effective in managing the rodent population.

Pests such as rodents and insects can introduce pathogens, parasites, and environmental contaminants that pose direct health risks to animals. Contaminated feed or water can also diminish animal welfare, reduce nutritional quality, and create stressful or unsafe living conditions.

An effective program for control of insects, external parasites affecting nonhuman primates, and birds and mammals that are pests, must be established and maintained so as to promote the health and well-being of the animals and reduce contamination by pests in animal areas.

3.125(a) Repeat

Facilities, general.

The facility failed to keep two wooden structures and a wooden fence in good repair in the capybara enclosure. Two wooden structures have exposed nail points, pushed out wooden boards, and broken pieces creating sharp points. The posts supporting one of the structures are starting to rot. The fence separating the capybara from a tortoise yard has broken wooden boards and sharp points.

Failure to adequately maintain primary enclosures places animals at significant risk. Structural defects or poor upkeep can result in preventable injuries, opportunities for escape, or even death of the animals housed within.

The facility must be constructed of such material and of such strength as appropriate for the animals involved. The indoor and outdoor housing facilities shall be structurally sound and shall be maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

3.131(a)

Sanitation.

The facility has failed to clean the pool in the Capybara enclosure. The facility has a bathtub that serves as a pool for two Capybaras. The pool has murky, brownish-yellow water and scattered surface debris with filamentous algae growing on the surface of the water. Green algae is also present along the water's edge.

Dirty water can harbor bacteria, parasites, and algae that lead to skin, eye, and gastrointestinal infections. Poor water quality can increase stress, especially for species that rely on swimming for comfort, exercise, or cooling.

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Cleaning of Enclosures. Excreta shall be removed from primary enclosures as often as necessary to prevent contamination of the animals contained therein and to minimize disease hazards and to reduce odors. When enclosures are cleaned by hosing or flushing, adequate measures shall be taken to protect the animals confined in such enclosures from being directly sprayed with the stream of water or wetted involuntarily. Correct this day, August 12, 2026, forward.

3.131(c)

Sanitation.

The facility has a build up of dirt, debris, trash, and clutter in the room used for food prep and food storage. There is debris, trash, old cat food cans all surrounding the containers used to store dry food for the animals. One container holding food pellets for the Capybara has cobwebs in it. There are two baskets of rotting fruit on a shelf underneath the counter being used to prepare fruit and vegetable diets. There is multiple areas of clutter throughout the room.

Maintaining a clean, uncluttered food prep and storage area is essential for animal welfare. Clutter and trash increase the risk of contamination, attract pests, and compromise food safety. Improper food handling can directly affect the health of multiple species, making strict sanitation practices critical.

Housekeeping. Premises (buildings and grounds) shall be kept clean and in good repair in order to protect the animals from injury and to facilitate the prescribed husbandry practices set forth in this subpart. Accumulations of trash shall be placed in designated areas and cleared as necessary to protect the health of the animals. Correct by August 19, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

Additional Inspectors:

Colette Kirk El-Amin, Supervisory Animal Care Specialist

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
329044	58-C-1207	001	Wellington Conservation Center	12-AUG-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000004	<i>Varecia variegata</i>	BLACK-AND-WHITE RUFFED LEMUR
000003	<i>Sus scrofa domestica</i>	DOMESTIC PIG / POTBELLY PIG / MICRO PIG
000002	<i>Vulpes pallida</i>	PALE FOX
000002	<i>Hydrochaeris hydrochaeris</i>	CAPYBARA
000002	<i>Choloepus hoffmanni</i>	HOFFMANN'S TWO-TOED SLOTH
000004	<i>Notamacropus rufogriseus</i>	BENNETT'S WALLABY / RED-NECKED WALLABY
000002	<i>Varecia rubra</i>	RED RUFFED LEMUR
000001	<i>Cynomys ludovicianus</i>	BLACK-TAILED PRAIRIE DOG
000002	<i>Procyon lotor</i>	RACCOON
000001	<i>Struthio camelus</i>	COMMON OSTRICH
000002	<i>Lemur catta</i>	RING-TAILED LEMUR
000025	Total	